



Notification Waiver Determination

Hillhouse – LRQA Group

Acquisition	Atlas Investments Holdings Limited (Atlas BidCo), which is indirectly and wholly-owned by certain funds managed and/or advised by Hillhouse Investment Management, Ltd. (Hillhouse) and its affiliates, applied for a notification waiver in respect of its proposed acquisition of a minority stake in Dione Topco Ltd. (Dione Topco), as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	18 July 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, Hillhouse, is a global investment firm that primarily invests in the fields of business services, healthcare, consumer, education, and real assets sectors. The target, Dione Topco, is the holding company for the indirectly wholly owned group of companies comprising LRQA Group Limited (LRQA, together with its subsidiaries, the LRQA Group). The LRQA Group is a global provider of inspection and certification services to both public and private sector customers with customers across a range of industries, including energy and renewables, construction, food and beverage, consumer goods manufacturing, and technology, amongst others. The LRQA Group is headquartered in Birmingham, United Kingdom, and with offices across Europe, the Americas, Asia Pacific, and the Middle East. The LRQA Group's services can be divided into four service areas: (a) assessment and certification services, (b) inspection services, (c) data analytics and consulting services (including environmental, social and governance (ESG)), and (d) cybersecurity services. One of Hillhouse's portfolio companies, Ascentium, also offers ESG consulting services.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). Based on the information provided in the application, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition. In particular:

	a. there is no overlap between Hillhouse (and its connected entities) and LRQA Group in the supply of testing, inspection and certification services in Australia b. there is a small overlap between Hillhouse (and its connected entities) and LRQA Group in the supply of ESG consulting services in Australia c. there are alternative suppliers of testing, inspection and certification, and ESG consulting services in Australia. In these circumstances, the ACCC does not consider it necessary to reach a concluded view on the likelihood of the notification thresholds being met. Given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC's interim guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
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Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act